

Updated Product Roadmap

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Executive Direction

The product should evolve from a manual expense tracker into a financial decision platform. The strongest near-term positioning is not a generic budgeting app. The best wedge is a practical cash-flow copilot for freelancers, consultants, solo professionals, and eventually small teams.

The product should answer questions users actively care about:

- Can I safely spend money this week?
- What bills, taxes, or cash-flow risks are coming?
- Which expenses, subscriptions, or behaviors need attention?
- What repeated spending patterns are quietly hurting my goals?
- What action should I take now?
- What would happen if I changed this behavior by 10%, 25%, or 50%?
- What changed since last week?

AI should appear as operational intelligence and action recommendations, not as a chatbot-first feature.

Target Users

Primary Initial Segment: Freelancers And Solo Professionals

This segment has a clearer willingness to pay than generic consumers because money management is tied to taxes, invoices, runway, client timing, and business survival.

Key pain points:

- Irregular income makes monthly budgeting unreliable.
- Receipts and expenses are tedious to organize.
- Tax reserves are easy to underfund.
- Deadlines for taxes, insurance, accounting, invoices, and administrative obligations are easy to miss.
- Users need cash-flow clarity before making spending decisions.
- Personal and business expenses often mix.
- Existing tools show data but rarely recommend timely actions.

Secondary Segment: Shared Households

Shared households are useful for validating multi-member accounts and fair-split logic, but the monetization ceiling may be lower.

Key pain points:

- Shared expenses are difficult to split fairly.
- Recurring bills create recurring disputes.
- Members need visibility without giving everyone full control.

Later Segment: Small Businesses

Small businesses should come later, after the product proves its intelligence layer with simpler workflows.

Key pain points:

- Cash-flow forecasting.
- Invoice and payment monitoring.
- Reporting.
- Cost optimization.
- Approval workflows.
- Financial document automation.

Product Positioning

Recommended positioning:

"An AI cash-flow copilot for freelancers and small teams that turns financial data into timely, explainable actions."

Avoid positioning as:

- Another expense tracker.
- A generic budgeting app.
- A chatbot for finance.
- A full accounting replacement at MVP stage.

Differentiation

The product can stand out by combining:

- Cash-flow decisioning instead of passive dashboards.
- Scheduled pattern detection instead of one-off reports.
- Agentic recommendations with human approval.
- Explainable financial reasoning.
- Personalized recurring-bill, tax, runway, and anomaly logic.
- Deadline, obligation, and opportunity monitoring for professional users.
- Practical workflows around receipts, invoices, exports, and reports.
- Strong privacy, role-based access, and auditability.

AI should be used where it reduces work or improves decisions:

- Categorization.
- Receipt and invoice extraction.
- Pattern detection.
- Recommendation simulation.
- Deadline and obligation monitoring.
- Forecast explanation.
- Recommendation generation.
- Action queue prioritization.

Pattern Intelligence And Recommendations

This should become a core product capability, not a decorative insight panel.

The product should periodically analyze spending, income, recurring obligations, and user goals, then produce specific recommendations with evidence and estimated impact. For example:

- "You spent EUR X on Friday nights in the last eight weeks. If you reduce this by 25%, your emergency fund date moves forward by Y weeks."
- "Your subscriptions increased by X% since March. Here are the three largest contributors."
- "Your client payments usually arrive around day X, but this month your next bill is due earlier. Keep EUR Y reserved."
- "You are on pace to underfund taxes by EUR X this quarter."

High-value recommendation format:

- Observation: what pattern was detected.
- Evidence: transactions, dates, categories, and trend.
- Impact: cash-flow, tax reserve, runway, goal, or deadline effect.
- Options: realistic actions at different effort levels.
- Confidence: why the system believes this matters.
- User control: dismiss, snooze, accept, mark irrelevant, or turn into an action.

This should start rules-first. AI can help summarize, personalize tone, and explain trade-offs, but the first version should not depend on opaque model reasoning for financial calculations.

Professional Deadline And Opportunity Intelligence

For freelancers and professionals, the product can become more valuable by monitoring obligations and opportunities, not only expenses.

Useful reminders:

- Tax/VAT/social insurance/accounting filing deadlines.
- Invoice follow-up and payment deadlines.
- Contract renewal or subscription renewal dates.
- Cash reserve deadlines for expected obligations.
- Funding, grant, or subsidy deadlines where eligibility can be inferred from the user's profile.
- Regulatory or law-change alerts that may affect the user's business, tax position, reporting duties, or available benefits.

This capability should be handled carefully:

- It should not pretend to provide legal, tax, or accounting advice without professional review.
- Every external alert should include source, jurisdiction, publication date, applicability assumptions, and confidence.
- User confirmation should be required before acting on anything external or compliance-sensitive.
- The system should prefer "this may affect you; review this source or speak to a professional" over definitive legal conclusions.

The law-change and funding-monitoring idea may justify a separate project or service if it can serve multiple products. My recommendation is to keep it as a separate bounded domain conceptually, but integrate it later through an API or data feed. In this finance app, start with manual/professional calendars and curated deadline templates before building a broad legal-monitoring platform.

Roadmap Phases

Phase 0: Stabilized Manual MVP

Objective: Make the current product reliable enough to use manually.

Target users: Founder, pilot users, friendly testers.

Problems addressed:

- Basic account and expense organization.
- Shared account visibility.
- Recurring expenses.
- Budget snapshot.

Features:

- Real account creation with owner membership.
- Expense search and filtering.
- Category selection.
- Multi-currency totals.
- Recurring templates and pending generated expenses.
- Financial profile.
- Basic budget health.
- Member roles.

Technical work:

- Clean repo structure.
- Track dependency and setup files.
- Fix migrations and model mismatches.
- Fix scheduler behavior.
- Enforce backend authorization.
- Stabilize Reflex UI.
- Add root documentation.
- Add CI-ready test commands.

Risks:

- Current pseudo-auth is unsafe.
- UI is temporary.
- Migrations may not upgrade existing data safely.

Success metrics:

- Fresh setup works from README.

- Tests pass.
- A user can create an account, add expenses, see totals, and manage members.

Exit criteria:

- No known critical correctness bugs.
- No global data leaks in API reads.
- A clean branch can be used as the new build base.

Phase 1: Freelancer Cash-Flow MVP

Objective: Deliver a narrow product that helps freelancers decide what they can safely do with money.

Target users: Freelancers, consultants, solo professionals.

Problems addressed:

- Irregular income.
- Tax reserve planning.
- Upcoming bills.
- Safe-to-spend uncertainty.

Features:

- Safe-to-spend v0.
- Manual or CSV transaction import.
- Upcoming bills from recurring templates.
- Monthly income and irregular income profile.
- Tax reserve estimate.
- Tax and administrative deadline reminders v0.
- Cash runway.
- Weekly financial summary.
- Action inbox with explainable recommendations.
- Scheduled pattern insights with simple impact simulations.

Technical work:

- Import pipeline.
- Transaction normalization.
- Rules-based recommendation engine.
- Notification-ready event model.
- Audit log for recommendations.
- Basic insight evaluation fixtures.
- Deadline calendar model.
- Scheduled insight generation job.

Dependencies:

- Stable transaction model.
- Reliable financial profile.
- Recurring template engine.

Risks:

- Safe-to-spend logic must be trusted.
- Users may not maintain manual data.

Success metrics:

- Users check the Today page at least weekly.
- Users act on recommendations.
- Users mark pattern insights as useful rather than noisy.
- Users avoid or prepare for at least one deadline.
- Users report lower uncertainty about spending.
- At least a small cohort expresses willingness to pay.

Exit criteria:

- 5 to 10 pilot users complete four weekly cycles.
- Safe-to-spend and runway are understandable and trusted.

Phase 2: Automation And Document Intelligence

Objective: Reduce manual work and improve data quality.

Target users: Paid individual/professional users.

Problems addressed:

- Manual transaction entry.
- Receipt organization.
- Categorization errors.
- Missing tax/accounting records.

Features:

- Receipt OCR.
- PDF/image storage.
- Intelligent transaction categorization.
- Duplicate detection.
- Subscription detection.
- CSV/PDF exports.
- Recommendation confidence and evidence display.

Technical work:

- File storage.
- OCR provider integration.
- Document extraction pipeline.
- Review queue.
- Categorization model or LLM classifier.
- Evaluation set for extraction and classification.
- PII handling and retention policies.

Dependencies:

- Auth and data governance.
- Storage layer.
- Background jobs.

Risks:

- OCR and AI costs.
- Privacy concerns.
- Extraction quality.

Success metrics:

- Reduced manual data-entry time.
- High accepted categorization rate.
- Low correction rate for extracted receipts.

Exit criteria:

- Users import or upload data repeatedly.
- Document intelligence materially improves retention.

Phase 3: Proactive Financial Intelligence

Objective: Detect risk before the user notices it.

Target users: Pro users and small teams.

Problems addressed:

- Spending drift.
- Cash-flow surprises.
- Underfunded goals or taxes.
- Unusual activity.

Features:

- Anomaly detection.
- Behavioral spending insights.
- Repeated-behavior detection, such as weekly/monthly habit patterns.
- Recommendation impact simulation.
- Predictive burn rate.
- Goal impact analysis.
- Self-adjusting goal projections.
- Cash-flow calendar.
- What changed since last week.
- Notification preferences for alerts, digests, and deadlines.

Technical work:

- Time-series features.
- Baseline and anomaly models.

- Forecasting service module.
- Explanation generation.
- Insight ranking.
- Offline evaluation.
- User feedback loop for accepted, dismissed, irrelevant, and snoozed insights.
- Alert throttling to avoid notification fatigue.

Dependencies:

- Clean historical transaction data.
- User feedback loop.

Risks:

- False positives can destroy trust.
- Insights can become noise.

Success metrics:

- Alert precision.
- Recommendation acceptance.
- Reduced churn among active users.

Exit criteria:

- Users rely on alerts and weekly summary as a habit.

Phase 4: Agentic Workflows

Objective: Move from recommendations to approved actions.

Target users: Advanced professionals and small businesses.

Problems addressed:

- Repetitive financial operations.
- Receipt matching.
- Invoice follow-up.
- Reporting.
- Cost optimization.

Features:

- Action inbox.
- Agent-generated reports.
- Invoice/payment monitoring.
- Deadline monitoring and reminder escalation.
- Funding opportunity watchlist for eligible users.
- Regulatory/law-change watchlist as a separate bounded capability or external service integration.
- Drafted vendor/client emails.
- Subscription cancellation guidance.
- Tax reserve and transfer recommendations.

- Accounting export workflows.

Technical work:

- Agent orchestration layer.
- Tool registry.
- Approval policy engine.
- Action ledger.
- Rollback/undo where possible.
- Guardrails and output validation.
- Human confirmation for risky actions.

Dependencies:

- Auth.
- Audit logs.
- Integrations.
- Evaluation framework.
- Trusted external data sources for deadlines, funding, and law-change monitoring.

Risks:

- Regulatory boundaries.
- User trust.
- Bad automated actions.

Success metrics:

- Approved actions per active user.
- Time saved.
- Low reversal or complaint rate.

Exit criteria:

- Agents reliably perform bounded workflows with clear evidence and approvals.

Phase 5: Business Expansion

Objective: Expand into freelancers, startups, and small businesses.

Target users: Small teams, agencies, startups, SMBs.

Problems addressed:

- Business cash-flow forecasting.
- Expense/revenue intelligence.
- Invoice and payment monitoring.
- Reporting.
- Operational alerts.

Features:

- Team roles and approvals.
- Business cash-flow forecast.

- Invoice tracking.
- Revenue and expense intelligence.
- Scenario planning.
- Cost optimization.
- Export to accounting tools.

Technical work:

- Organization model.
- Business entities.
- Integrations.
- More robust workflow engine.
- Observability and SLAs.
- Data retention controls.

Risks:

- Accounting complexity.
- Integration maintenance.
- Support burden.

Success metrics:

- Paid conversion.
- Retention.
- Forecast accuracy.
- Report/export usage.

Exit criteria:

- Business users pay for operational workflows, not just dashboards.

Features To Remove Or Postpone

Postpone:

- Gamified savings challenges.
- Full bank aggregation before validation.
- Full autonomous agents.
- Broad legal/law-change monitoring before narrow professional deadline validation.
- Business microservices.
- Complex simulations.
- Broad global consumer positioning.

Potentially remove from near-term scope:

- Decorative chatbot UI.
- Generic charts that do not drive decisions.
- Social features not tied to a clear financial outcome.

Validation Plan

Before expensive features:

- Interview freelancers and solo professionals.
- Run a concierge weekly financial report.
- Test fake-door buttons for safe-to-spend, OCR, anomaly alerts, and tax reserve.
- Run a concierge "Friday pattern" or "weekly leak" report for pilot users.
- Run a concierge professional-deadline calendar for freelancers.
- Test fake-door buttons for funding alerts and law-change alerts before building source monitoring.
- Validate willingness to pay before bank aggregation.
- Use CSV uploads before regulated financial account aggregation.

Critical assumptions:

- Users will share/import financial data if value is clear.
- Safe-to-spend is more valuable than generic budgets.
- Users want specific pattern recommendations more than generic charts.
- Professionals will pay for deadline/opportunity monitoring if alerts are accurate and timely.
- Law-change monitoring is valuable enough to justify a separate service only if source coverage and applicability can be trusted.
- Freelancers will pay for tax/runway clarity.
- Explainable recommendations build trust.

Recommended Next Product Step

Build the Today page around:

- Safe-to-spend.
- Upcoming bills.
- Month-end projection.
- Tax reserve status.
- Action inbox.
- Pattern insights and recommendation simulations.
- Deadline reminders.
- Recent important transactions.

This page should become the product's identity.